larger share of the popular vote at the November 2015 elections than the NLD.

12 According to Asian Barometer research conducted nationwide in early 2015, over fifty per cent of respondents declined to name the party they intended to vote for at the November election. While this reluctance could be due to privacy concerns, the fact that respondents were willing to provide an assessment of President Thein Sein's administration suggests a lack of surety — especially given the research was conducted more than nine months out from the elections. See Welsh and Huang, this volume.

13 Myanmar was recently listed as 'the most generous' country in the world by the World Giving Index. Studies of household budgets and reciprocity in Myanmar are rare, especially on a widespread basis, although the absence of the state and strength of social welfare groups throughout much of the country suggests such findings are likely to be broadly accurate. For a discussion of everyday reciprocity practices, see Griffiths (2015).

14 Further fieldwork revealed that the electricity grid was in fact a community-financed project, not supported by the government, though this family gave credit to the government regardless.

15 See for instance, Asia Foundation (2014), International Republican Institute (2014), Welsh and Huang, this volume.

16 See Geertz (1959), Nishizaki (2011), and MacLean (2010) for overviews of the literature on informal institutions and political processes.

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